Our World in Emissions

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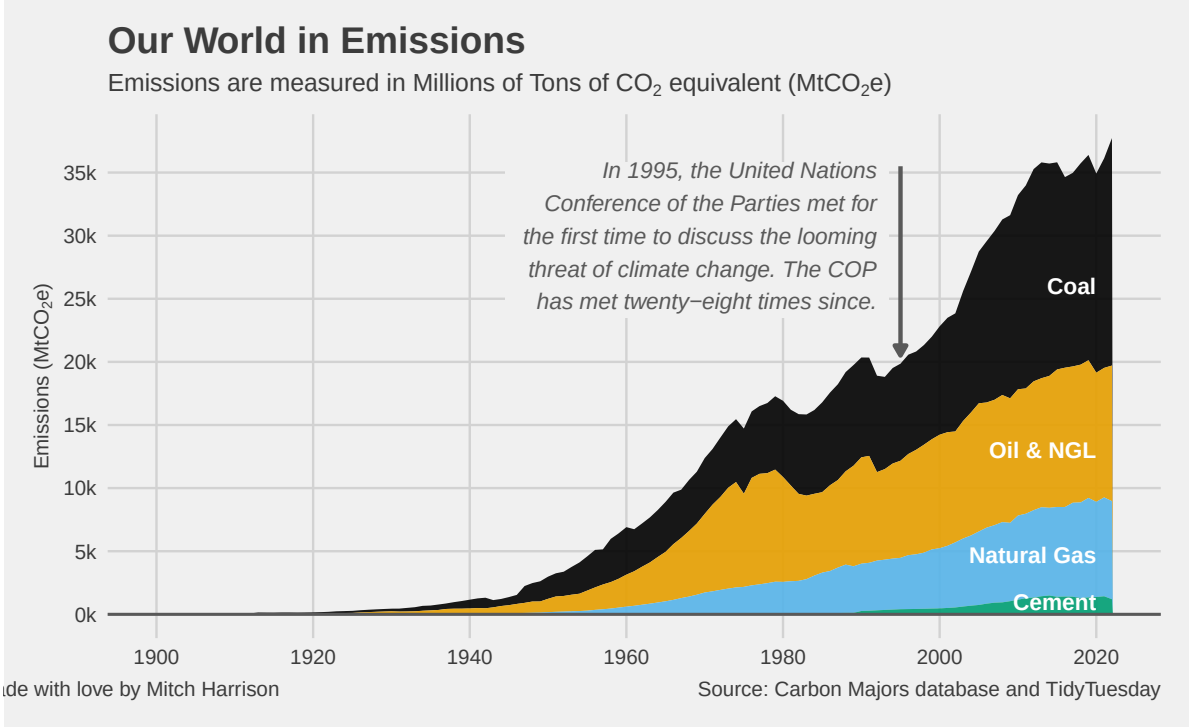
Hello, all! Welcome to TidyTuesday. This week, as climate analysts often do, we are going to get mildly depressing in pursuit of a pretty graph. This time, we will look at emissions from various actors' coal, natural gas, and cement production. Spoiler: it's not good.

The data for this week are brought to us by Carbon Majors, who have compiled a database going all the way back to the 1850's! The dataset contains emission data for 75 state and non-state actors, but we will aggregate into total emissions by type for the plot. If you want to get more granular in your own plot, check out the data on the TidyTuesday GitHub repository here!



So there she is! As we can see, the UN COP seems to be fighting an uphill battle. Emissions are rising, but a good analyst must note the limitations of the data. What jumps out to me is that renewables aren't listed here because it's only a graph of emissions. For all we know (from this graph), these emissions only produce a small portion of the world's energy, and we are arguing about a couple of percentage points. Maybe we have defeated climate change after all!

Of course, that's not the case, but proving that point will require outside data. So, I welcome everyone reading to write a fuller report using more evidence. If nothing else, it would make for some fun data viz practice!

If you want a step-by-step guide to how I made this plot, there is a tutorial page here, or even stop by my Discord server and ask me! And, of course, if you appreciate my work enough to buy me a coffee, you can do so here. Thank you for reading, and see you next week!